

JSS 3 NIGERIAN HISTORY – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 2: LEADERSHIP IN CONTEMPORARY NIGERIA

1. Past Presidents (Fourth Republic – Overview)

Since 1999, Nigeria has had civilian presidents including Olusegun Obasanjo, Umaru Musa Yar'Adua, Goodluck Jonathan, Muhammadu Buhari and later successors. Each administration faced issues of security, economy, corruption and national unity, with different policies and legacies.

2. Impacts of Leadership

Leaders influence policy on education, health, infrastructure, security and foreign relations. Effective leadership can improve stability and development; weak or divisive leadership can deepen crises. Citizens also shape outcomes through voting, activism and demand for accountability.

3. Lessons for Students

Study leaders' decisions in context; evaluate results fairly; recognise that leadership is not only the president but also governors, legislators and community figures. Good citizenship includes holding leaders to account.

4. Summary

Contemporary Nigerian leadership under democracy has brought continuity of civilian rule and mixed records on development and security. Understanding past presidents' impacts helps explain today's challenges.

End of Topic 2